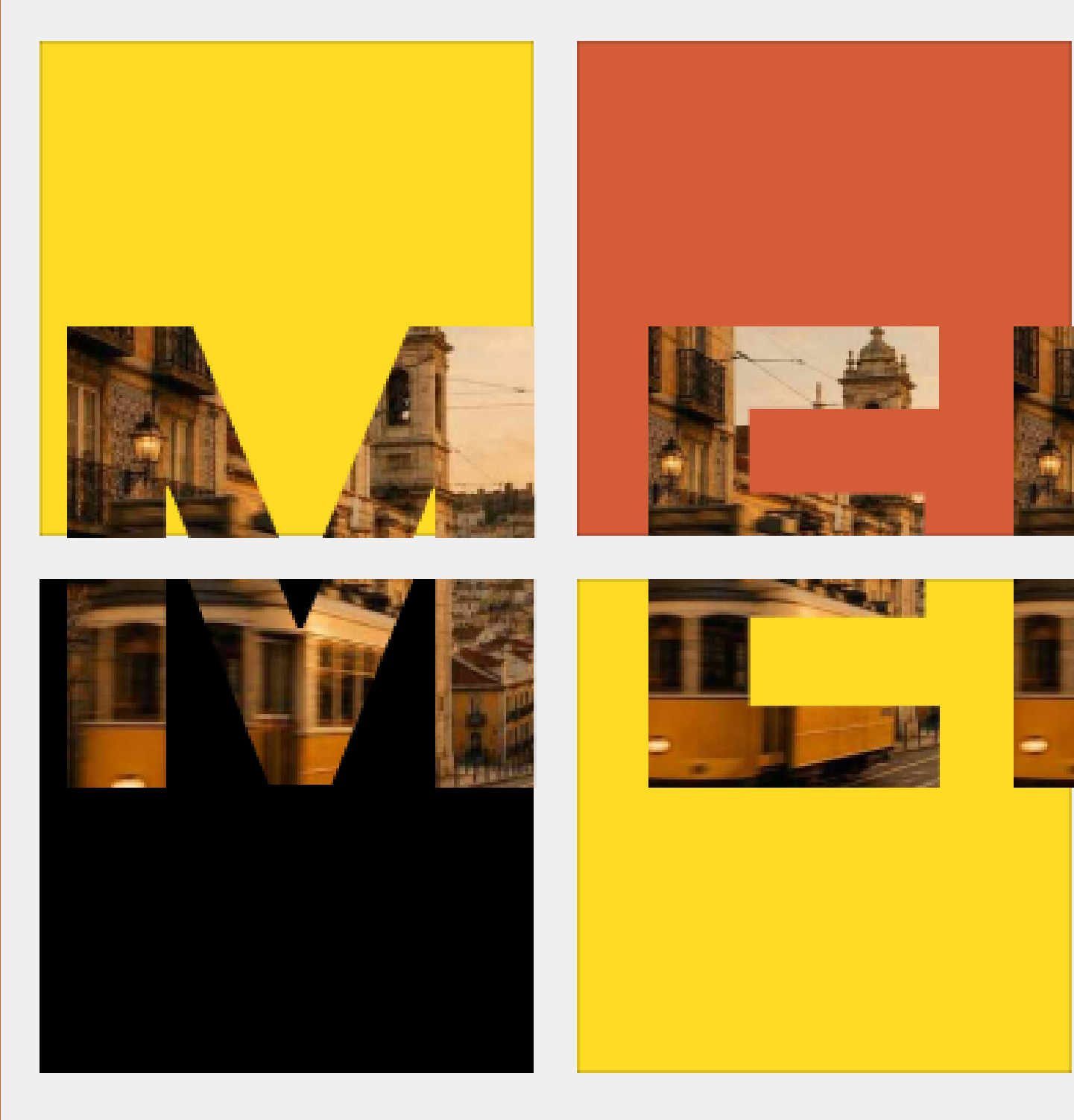


YOUR WAY 2026 · REGION 04 · SPAIN

FROM IDEA TO SUBMISSION

OCT 2026 · SPAIN

VICTOR ESTIVAL · FACILITATOR



IN PARTNERSHIP WITH



SPEAKER



VICTOR ESTIVAL

Facilitator · Nerdy

Over twenty years in enterprise infrastructure, eleven in technical marketing. Product marketing at Chainlink, Polkadot, Polygon and Algorand. Chain-agnostic by choice.

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SESSION AGENDA

01	Learn from winners and read the rules	20 MIN
02	Choose a problem and differentiate	25 MIN
03	Scope the MVP and design the demo	30 MIN
04	Evidence, pitch and peer review	45 MIN



TODAY'S GOAL

FOUR DELIVERABLES

Every team leaves with:

- A differentiated proposal
- A scope you can ship in two days
- A demo script with a verifiable result
- An evidence canvas and a submission checklist



“WINNERS SHOW
PATTERNS,
NOT FORMULAS.”

HACK



CHOOSE YOUR TRACK

01

GENESIS

Idea to MVP. First-time Stellar builders, early founders, domain experts.

02

SCALE

Prototype to product. A working product ready for a real Stellar integration.

03

HOW TO PICK

Shipped before, or an advanced prototype? Scale. Starting from a problem? Genesis.



WHAT LISBON PRIORITIZES

01

SMART CONTRACTS

Named as a top priority this year.
Soroban logic doing real work.

02

SMART ACCOUNTS

Also a stated priority. Relevant to
Genesis and Scale alike.

03

CROSS-CHAIN

Cross-chain transfers, the third
priority on the list.



HACKMERIDIAN RIO

Two tracks, winners per track (official SDF recap):

- Open Innovation, 1st: The Simple Fund, an on-chain receivables fund with a tradable token
- Composability, 1st: Lance, a freelance marketplace paid through smart contracts
- Composability asked teams to build on Blend, Soroswap, DeFindex, Kale and Reflector
- Lesson: pick the track on purpose and reuse live protocols



BUILDER SUMMIT

Six tracks, 12 winners. Two tracks worth studying:

- Agentic Payments, 1st: StellarPay, one middleware for x402 and MPP
- Agentic Payments, 2nd: a discovery layer for what agents can pay for
- Dev Tooling, 1st: Stellar Memory, links a repo to what is live on-chain
- Dev Tooling, 2nd: a CLI plugin that gates agent contract calls with on-chain policy
- Lesson: sharp infrastructure that removes one known pain



SIMPLIFY, THEN STAND OUT

Two online Stellar Hacks, two lessons:

- Blend, 1st: Blend Pool Creator, a guided wizard to launch lending pools
- Lesson: making a live protocol easy to use is a product
- Agents, top 5: Cards402, CleverCon, RenderGate, x402-mcp-stellar-template, TollPay
- Each one ends in a real payment an agent needs to finish a task
- SDF saw four or five near-identical agent registries in a single event



FIND YOUR OPPORTUNITY

Pick by team fit, difficulty and demo, not by odds:

- Composability: milestone payouts for one sector. Demo: fund, approve, release
- Agent payments: buy a service under a budget. Demo: one valid payment, one rejected overspend
- Dev tooling: remove one deploy friction. Demo: before and after
- Local payments: collect and reconcile for one trade. Demo: full flow, simulations labeled
- Smart accounts or cross-chain: simplify a flow. Demo: the step that disappears



CHECK THE ALTERNATIVES

Before you write a line of code:

- Search past Stellar hackathon submissions on DoraHacks for your idea
- Scan stellar.org/ecosystem and Stellar Community Fund projects
- Name three alternatives, including a spreadsheet or doing nothing
- Write the one thing you do that they don't
- Same thing already built? Narrow the user or change the angle



USER, PROBLEM, WHY STELLAR

One line per prompt, on the Project Canvas:

- Who has the problem? Role, place, size
- How do they solve it today, and what does it cost them?
- What changes for them with your project?
- Why Stellar: what breaks or gets worse without it?
- For [user] who [problem], we [result], using Stellar to [reason]



SCOPE

ONE JOURNEY

1 flow

One user, from action to verifiable result.
Everything else goes on a roadmap slide.

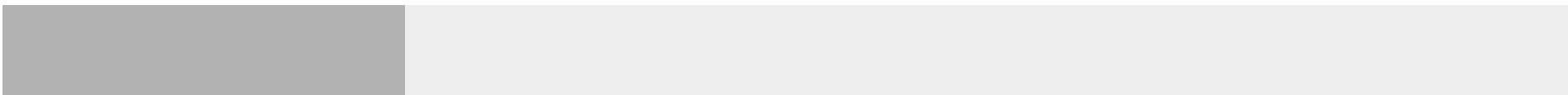
WORKSHOP RECOMMENDATION

SCOPE

WHAT TEAMS PLAN ON DAY ONE



WHAT SHIPS IN TWO DAYS



BAR LENGTHS ARE ILLUSTRATIVE, NOT MEASURED



DESIGN A VERIFIABLE DEMO

01

ACTION

What the user does, in one sentence.
One user, one journey.

02

INTEGRATION

What Stellar does at that moment: a
contract call, a payment, an account.

03

RESULT

What a judge can check: a
transaction, an explorer link, a state
change.



A JUDGE-FRIENDLY README

Lisbon's FAQ: a clear README does most of the work.

- One line: user, problem, result
- How it works: architecture and the Stellar pieces used
- Run it: setup steps that work on a clean machine
- Proof: network, contract IDs, explorer links, demo video
- Honesty: what is simulated, what is reused, what you built here



DURING THE EVENT

SHOW YOUR PROGRESS

01

KEEP A LOG

Decisions, blockers and fixes as they happen. Mentors see the path.

02

NAME YOUR PART

What you reused, what you built during the event. Say it plainly.

03

USE FEEDBACK

Ask mentors early. Show what changed because of what they said.



PITCH, REVIEW, IMPROVE



01
PRESENT

Three minutes: user, problem, demo, evidence.

02
SCORE

Peers rate clarity, difference, integration, evidence.

03
CHALLENGE

Flag every claim you could not verify.

04
COMMIT

Three actions, ranked, each with an owner.



BEFORE YOU SUBMIT

SUBMISSION CHECKLIST

Tick every line, then write your top three fixes:

- Track, deadlines and required deliverables checked against the rules
- Rules on prior code, licenses and AI use read
- Public repo, reproducible setup, links tested from a logged-out browser
- Network, contract IDs and transactions listed
- Simulations and limits declared; reused versus built explained
- Demo and video inside the time limit, plus a backup recording



FOR YOUR TEAM

TAKE THE KIT

Project & Evidence Canvas, Demo & Pitch Playbook, Submission Checklist, a worked example and these slides. Word and PDF, free to reuse.



Scan for the kit

KEEP BUILDING

APPLY TO HACKMERIDIAN

Lisbon, October 25 and 26. Genesis or Scale. Travel support for selected builders. Applications are reviewed on a rolling basis: apply early.



hackmeridian.com



THANK YOU

QUESTIONS?

VICTOR ESTIVAL · [LINKEDIN.COM/IN/VESTIVAL](https://www.linkedin.com/in/vestival) · [HACKMERIDIAN.COM](https://hackmeridian.com)



APPLY FOR LISBON



THE KIT

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SOURCES

Every fact in this deck, checked on 23 September 2026:

- Lisbon tracks and priorities: hackmeridian.com/build and hackmeridian.com/faq
- Rio 2025 winners by track: stellar.org/blog/foundation-news/the-blueprint-at-meridian-2025
- São Paulo 2026 Builder Summit winners: developers.stellar.org/meetings/2026/08/13
- Stellar Hacks: Agents winners: dorahacks.io/hackathon/stellar-agents-x402-stripe-mpp/winner
- Agents standouts and the registry warning: developers.stellar.org/meetings/2026/04/23
- Stellar Hacks: Blend winners: dorahacks.io/hackathon/stellar-hacks-blend/winner
- PULSO scoring criteria: pulso-hackaton.com, section "Critérios de pontuação"
- The kit: github.com/vestival/stellar-workshop-spain/tree/master/hackathon-kit



A REAL RUBRIC: PULSO

PULSO (NearX and SDF, Brazil, Argentina and Colombia, June 2026) published these weights. They are PULSO's, not HackMeridian Lisbon's.

- 35%: integration depth and technical complexity
- 25%: ecosystem impact
- 20%: customer discovery and validation, minimum three interviews
- 20%: deployment quality
- Exercise: for each line, write the evidence your project would show today. Empty lines are your to-do list.

